Fruit: A schizocarp with spiny outgrowth, splits into three one seeded cocci.

Seed: Endospermous, knob-like caruncle develops from the micropyle, that absorbs and temporarily retains water enabling germination.

Floral Formula:

Male flower: $Br.,Ebrl.,\oplus,\sigma,P_{(5)},A_{\infty},G_{0}$

Female flower: $Br.,Ebrl.,\oplus,\varphi,P_{(3)},A_{0},\underline{G}_{(3)}$

Economic importance of the family Euphorbiaceae

Economic importance	Binomial	Useful part	Uses
Food plant	*Emblica officinalis* (நெல்லிக்காய்)	Fruits	Rich in vitamin C, which are edible and pickled.
	P. acidus (அரைநெல்லி)		
	Manihot esculenta (மரவள்ளி கிழங்கு / Tapioca)	Tuberous roots	Roots are rich in starch and used for preparing bread, biscuits, chips and other food stuffs.
Oil plant			
Croton oil	*Croton tiglium*	Seed	Used as a powerful purgative and also to treat skin diseases.
Castor Oil	*Ricinus communis* (ஆமணக்கு /Castor)	Seeds	Used as vegetable oil, ricinoleic acid present in this oil eliminate acne causing bacteria apart from that it acts as laxative and lubricant.
Jatropha Oil	*Jatropha curcas* (காட்டாமணக்கு)	Seeds	Used for biofuels.
Rubber:	*Hevea brasiliensis* (Para rubber)	Coagulated latex	Latex is used in rubber products like tube and tyre.
	Manihot glaziovii (Manicoba rubber)		
Medicinal plants	*Euphorbia resinifera*	Latex	*Euphorbium* drug is obtained from the latex and used as a purgative.
	Euphorbia hirta (அம்மான் பச்சரிசி)	Whole plant	Lactogogue
	Phyllanthus amarus (கீழாநெல்லி)	Entire shoot system	Used to treat Jaundice.
	Jatropha gossypifolia	Leaves and roots	Used in the treatment of leprosy and snakebite.
	Ricinus communis	Seed oil	Purgative

Continued

11th Botany_EM_Chapter 5.indd 132 06/01/2023 19:43:52